

TOPIC 2: QUR'ANIC RECITATION – SURATUL BALAD (Q90:1–20)

1. Introduction

Suratul Balad (The City) is a Makkan Surah with 20 verses. Allah swears by the sacred city (Makkah) and by the parent and offspring, and addresses the human condition of toil and the path of moral courage.

2. Key Themes

- Man is created in toil and hardship.
- Does he think that no one has power over him? He says he has spent wealth in abundance – does he think no one sees him?
- Allah has given him eyes, tongue and lips, and shown him the two highways.
- Yet he has not attempted the steep path: freeing a slave, feeding in time of hunger an orphan near of kin or a needy person in misery, and being of those who believe and encourage one another to patience and mercy.
- Those who reject the signs are the companions of the left; those who believe and do right are the companions of the right.

3. Lessons on Moral Courage

True courage is climbing the “steep path”: helping the oppressed and needy, believing, and encouraging patience and compassion. Wealth and speech without righteousness are empty.

4. Summary

Suratul Balad calls believers to the difficult but rewarding path of faith, charity and mutual encouragement to patience and mercy.

End of Topic 2